

MAHINDRA THAR ROXX



a departure angle of 36.1 degrees identical to the three-door. However, thanks to the longer wheelbase, the ramp-over angle is marginally lower at 23.9 degrees. Water wading capabilities too remain at 650mm and in all, the Roxx proves to be as potent a machine as the Thar.

The Thar Roxx comes with a completely revamped interior. However, it remains unmistakably a Thar. The dash comes with soft-touch pads and the stitching on it adds to the premium feel. The plaque on the passenger side remains identical to the three-door and somehow it makes you feel good. The 10.25-inch infotainment system comes with a plethora of functions which include displaying off-road data which we love. The system is also linked to a rather brilliant nine-speaker Harman/Kardon audio. The instrument panel is an all-digital affair and offers lots of data. At the same time, it is easy to read and sift through. The front seats are ventilated and the system works well. The driver's perch is electrically adjustable too. The seats themselves offer good comfort and although the overall upholstery comes in white, Mahindra tells us it is easy to clean. Additionally, the entire cabin comes with numerous grab handles which should come in handy off the road. The rear doors open up to an angle of 90 degrees. Now this has been done for easier ingress/egress as the door aperture is rather small. The footrest section at the back is also small but it sure aids in getting into the cabin. Adding to it is a strategically positioned grab handle. Once inside, the seats are comfortable and offer good space. The massive panoramic sunroof helps give the interiors a sense of space and airiness. There is a centre armrest as well with twin cup holders. This comes in handy as the door pockets are rather small. The rear AC vent console also comes with a USB-C charging port. Overall then, the rear seat is sure spacious. Thanks to the large dimensions, the Roxx comes with a substantially large 644-litre boot. It's a generous flat section which can hold quite a lot of luggage. A bonus is the 60:40 split seats which add to the versatility of storage space.

Mahindra Thar Roxx AX7L AT 4WD
Engine: 2.2-litre, 4-cylinder, turbo-diesel
Power: 175bhp@3,500rpm
Max torque 370Nm@1,500rpm
Gearbox: 6-speed AT
Price: ₹21 lakh (estimated)
On sale from October

We were driving the AX7L diesel automatic variant which comes with a 2.2-litre common rail diesel engine mated to a 6-speed automatic transmission. Power output stands at 175bhp and torque generated is 370Nm. This variant also features a 4WD system and comes with features like the Brake Lock Differential and even an Electric Locking Differential.

Step into the cabin and one feels invincible. Visibility up front is good and you'll surely feel like the king of the road. The NVH (noise, vibration, harness) packaging too is top class and the diesel engine is barely audible from within the cabin at any speed. The Roxx also takes off rather spiritedly and the speedo rapidly climbs up to 100kmph. Mahindra tells us that it can sprint to 60kmph in 4.8 seconds. At high speeds, the Roxx holds its ground well and is far better than the three-door version. Body roll is also controlled and the suspension absorbs well. There is a sense of confidence at high speeds and one feels nicely in control. However, at slower speeds, the ride quality is a bit stiffer and bumps on the road make their way into the cabin. Is it very harsh? Nope. But what is a game changer is the fact that the steering is rather light and offers good feedback too. Turning around such a large car is easier than many other smaller SUVs. ■